

Laravel Technical Interview Q&A;

Q1. Explain Laravel request lifecycle.

When a request comes, it enters through public/index.php → loads Composer autoload → Kernel.php → Service Providers → Routes → Middleware → Controller/Action → Response back to browser.

Q2. Difference between web.php and api.php?

web.php contains routes that use session state, CSRF protection, and cookies. api.php is for stateless APIs, usually returning JSON, without session or CSRF middleware.

Q3. What is Middleware in Laravel?

Middleware acts as a filter for HTTP requests before they reach controllers. Types: Global middleware (for all requests), Route middleware (for specific routes), and Custom middleware (developer defined).

Q4. Difference between Eloquent ORM and Query Builder.

Eloquent is an Active Record ORM that maps models to DB tables with object-oriented syntax. Query Builder provides a fluent interface to build DB queries but returns arrays/objects, not models.

Q5. Authentication vs Authorization?

Authentication verifies user identity (login). Authorization decides what actions a user can perform (roles, permissions).

Q6. Explain CSRF protection in Laravel.

Laravel includes a CSRF token in every form. The middleware verifies this token on requests to prevent cross-site request forgery.

Q7. Explain one-to-one, one-to-many, and many-to-many relationships.

One-to-one: A user has one profile. One-to-many: A post has many comments. Many-to-many: Students belong to many courses, and courses have many students.

Q8. What is the difference between cookies and sessions in Laravel?

Cookies store small data in the client's browser. Sessions store data on the server side but identified by a session ID stored in a cookie.

Q9. How to create and use a custom validation rule?

Use Artisan command: `php artisan make:rule CustomRule`. Implement `passes()` and `message()` methods, then use it in request validation.

Q10. What is the difference between public and storage directories?

public/ holds assets accessible to the web (CSS, JS, images). storage/ holds logs, cache, and user-uploaded files, which should be accessed via symbolic link (`php artisan storage:link`).